

INT. BLAKE'S BEDROOM - NIGHT

Darkness.

STATIC crackles through an old HAM RADIO.

A hand carefully turns the tuning dial.

BLAKE MERCER, 26, dark hair, tired eyes, sits hunched over a desk crowded with radio equipment.

Beside it all sits a photograph.

Two boys, maybe fifteen, grin at the camera beside a lake. One is Blake. The other is EVAN.

Blake adjusts another dial.

BLAKE
Evan, this is Blake. Are you
receiving me?

Static.

Blake waits.

Nothing.

He marks something in a notebook.

Frequency. Time. Weather conditions.

Pages upon pages of identical entries.

EMILY (O.S.)
Blake?

Blake doesn't respond.

He changes frequencies.

BLAKE
Evan, this is Blake. Are you
receiving me?

EMILY (O.S.)
Blake!

BLAKE
What?

EMILY (O.S.)
Mom said you were making dinner.

Blake looks at the clock.

8:43 P.M.

A frozen pizza box sits unopened beside his bedroom door.

BLAKE

Crap.

Blake starts to get up.

STATIC POPS from the radio.

He freezes.

Slowly sits back down.

BLAKE (CONT'D)

Evan?

Nothing.

Blake leans closer.

BLAKE (CONT'D)

Evan, can you hear me?

EMILY, 11, appears in the doorway.

EMILY

I'm starving.

Blake raises a finger.

Wait.

Emily rolls her eyes.

Blake listens.

Only static.

EMILY (CONT'D)

He's not going to answer.

Blake looks at her.

A beat.

BLAKE

Pizza's by the door.

EMILY

You're supposed to make it.

BLAKE
You know how to use the oven.

EMILY
Mom said I'm not supposed to when
nobody's downstairs.

BLAKE
I'm upstairs.

EMILY
Exactly.

Blake looks back toward the radio.

Emily watches him.

EMILY (CONT'D)
How long are you gonna keep doing
this?

BLAKE
Doing what?

She gestures to everything.

The radio.

The notebooks.

The photograph.

EMILY
This.

Blake turns another dial.

BLAKE
Five more minutes.

EMILY
You said that an hour ago.

Blake doesn't answer.

Emily grabs the pizza.

EMILY (CONT'D)
Fine.

She disappears down the hall.

Blake looks after her.

Guilt.

He takes off his headphones and starts to stand.

A faint sound slips through them.

Blake stops.

He slowly puts them back on.

STATIC.

Then-

Something underneath it.

A voice?

Blake leans toward the radio.

BLAKE

Evan?

Nothing.

Blake waits.

The bedroom door remains open behind him.

From downstairs-

EMILY (O.S.)

Blake! How long do I put it in for?

Blake closes his eyes.

He looks toward the hallway.

Then back to the radio.

He switches it off.

Silence.

BLAKE

Coming!

Blake gets up.

As he passes the photograph, he stops.

Straightens it.

BLAKE (CONT'D)

Tomorrow.

He leaves.

The bedroom sits empty.

A beat.

The radio CLICKS.

Its display illuminates by itself.

STATIC fills the room.

Buried somewhere deep beneath it --

VOICE (V.O.)

...Blake...

CUT TO BLACK.